

SYED ZARAK HASSAN

Nottingham, England, United Kingdom (Open to Relocation) | +44 7746 712125 | syedzrk1000@gmail.com

[linkedin.com/in/zarak-hassan7](https://www.linkedin.com/in/zarak-hassan7) | github.com/darkyzowo | zarak-os.vercel.app

Professional Summary

Compliance and Information Security professional with 1 year of hands-on GRC experience across ISO 27001, ISO 9001, Cyber Essentials, vendor risk management, and endpoint security. Having previously managed 15+ client accounts end to end at Nexique, I bring a customer-first mindset into everything I do, including how I approach compliance work. At Thrive Learning, that meant not just owning the technical side of vendor audits and security controls, but using Vanta to actively guide internal stakeholders through supplier risk classifications, onboarding processes, and due diligence reviews in a way that was clear and actionable regardless of their technical background. The combination of client-facing delivery experience and hands-on compliance programme ownership means I understand both what customers are trying to achieve and how to help them get there. Currently completing an MSc in Cyber Security at Nottingham Trent University.

Technical Skills and Core Competencies

Compliance Frameworks: ISO 27001, ISO 9001, SOC 2, Cyber Essentials, NIST Framework, GDPR.

GRC and Customer Advisory: Compliance Programme Implementation, Vendor Risk Management, Third-Party Risk Management, DPA Tracking, Audit Readiness, Access Control.

Customer-Facing Tools: Vanta, Cakewalk, Jira, Pulseway, Kandji.

Security Operations: IAM, Endpoint Security, Incident Response, DLP, Vulnerability Management, Security Controls.

SIEM and Tooling: Splunk, Chronicle, Suricata, Wireshark, VirusTotal, BitDefender GravityZone.

Technical: Python, MySQL, Linux, macOS, Windows.

Professional Skills: Customer Onboarding, Stakeholder Engagement, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Pre-Sales Support, Strategic Planning, Project Management.

Professional Experience

Compliance Analyst - Thrive Learning, Nottingham, UK

September 2025 – Present | Fixed-term contract, September 2026

Key Achievements:

- Guided the business through a successful ISO 9001 Stage 1 audit by designing 6 end-to-end process flows and translating complex audit standards into clear, actionable steps for non-technical stakeholders.
- Delivered a critical RFI response for a high-value prospect by mapping security controls to client requirements, contributing directly to deal closure and successful client onboarding.
- Reduced DPA time-to-approval by 70% by owning and simplifying the company-wide DPA tracking process across procurement and business teams.
- Led end-to-end MDM migration to Kandji for 250+ endpoints with zero downtime, reducing IT support tickets by 40%.

Responsibilities:

- Owned third-party risk management and compliance audits for 50+ vendors in Vanta, maintaining up-to-date risk classifications and supporting ongoing customer assurance programmes.
- Maintained core GRC risk registers and security controls across vendor, asset, access control, and risk domains, identifying and remediating gaps to ensure continuous audit readiness.
- Managed 75+ application ownership records in Cakewalk, assigning security and business owners to ensure accountability across the application estate.
- Developed and maintained the company-wide DPA tracker, coordinating supplier and contract lifecycle activities with procurement to support GDPR compliance, data privacy obligations, and spend optimization.
- Delivered a critical RFI response for a high-value prospect by mapping security controls to client requirements, contributing directly to deal closure and successful client onboarding.
- Streamlined cross-functional compliance deliverables by completing customer due-diligence processes and security questionnaires, improving response speed and quality across the business.
- Monitored endpoint health and supported IT operations via Pulseway MDM, managing proactive incident tracking and Jira ticket resolution for end-user devices.

Lead Project Manager - Nexique Design Labs, Pakistan

September 2021 – August 2024

- Managed end-to-end project delivery for 15+ clients across onboarding, requirements gathering, and execution, generating \$8,500+ in revenue with a near-100% client satisfaction rate.
- Led and mentored a 5-person team, developing standardised onboarding workflows and operational processes to ensure consistent delivery quality.

Projects & Tools

VenderScope — Continuous Vendor Risk Intelligence Platform (Independent Project)

github.com/darkyzowo/venderscope | Live: venderscope.vercel.app

- Built directly from the frustration of managing 50+ vendor audits (on Vanta) manually at Thrive Learning. VenderScope monitors vendor estates 24/7 across HIBP, NVD/NIST, Shodan, and Companies House simultaneously, replacing point-in-time annual reviews with a live weighted risk scoring engine (0-100) with CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW classification.
- Used alongside Vanta in a real audit workflow to surface breach history, active CVEs, exposed infrastructure, and compliance posture signals including ISO 27001, SOC 2, GDPR, and Cyber Essentials evidence, giving a fuller picture of vendor risk than traditional platforms alone.
- Produces one-click PDF audit reports structured for ISO 27001 Annex A and Cyber Essentials reviews, written to be readable by both technical and non-technical stakeholders, with a risk score drift timeline showing how a vendor's posture changes over time.

ZARAK_OS — Immersive 3D Cyber-Noir Portfolio OS Web-App

<https://github.com/darkyzowo/zarak-os> | Live: <https://zarak-os.vercel.app/>

- Architected a high-fidelity, interactive "Cyber-Noir" operating system using React 19, TypeScript, and Three.js, simulating a terminal-driven 3D hacker workspace.
- Engineered a custom window manager with React Draggable and Framer Motion, implementing glassmorphism effects and complex state management for a multi-window desktop environment.
- Developed a functional terminal emulator supporting custom CLI commands (ssh, ls, open) and a realistic system boot sequence to demonstrate technical depth and command-line proficiency.
- Designed a themed biometric login sequence and a robust codebase to reflect a security first mindset, ensuring the project aligns with fundamental GRC principles.

Education

Master of Science in Cyber Security

Nottingham Trent University, UK | January 2025 – December 2026 (Expected)

- **Dissertation:** Investigated whether diagrammatic techniques improve auditor comprehension of complex systems, combining case studies and interviews to demonstrate measurable improvements in understanding at small scale.
- **Relevant modules:** Network Security, Digital Forensics, Secure Software Development and Ethical Hacking.

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

Iqra National University, Pakistan | February 2020 – February 2024

Certifications

Google Professional Cyber Security Certificate (2024) / [Coursera and Google](#)

- Hands-on labs in Linux, MySQL, and Python focused on incident response, log analysis, and network security fundamentals.

SOC Member (2024) / [LetsDefend and HackTheBox](#)

- Completed a hands-on SOC Analyst Learning Path through LetsDefend, focused on real-world threat detection, incident investigation, and response within a simulated Security Operations Center (SOC) environment.
- Analyzed and resolved real-world cyber attack scenarios, including Phishing, Malware detection, and Web Attacks.